Bún bò xào

Garlic beef on rice noodles and herbs, dressed with nước chấm

Serves 2 · **Prep** 15 min · **Cook** 10 min

A southern Vietnamese noodle bowl with no broth to simmer, so it comes together in the time the noodles take. Slice the beef thin and cook it fast in a very hot pan so it browns without stewing.

INGREDIENTS

For the bowl

- 150 g rice vermicelli
- 2 handfuls shredded lettuce
- 100 g bean sprouts
- 1 small bunch mint, leaves picked
- 1 small bunch coriander, leaves picked
- 2 tbsp crushed roasted peanuts
- 2 tbsp fried shallots

For the beef

- 300 g beef sirloin or flank, thinly sliced across the grain
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tbsp fish sauce
- 1 tsp sugar
- 1 tbsp neutral oil

For the sauce

- 150 ml nước chấm (recipe), thinned with water (see Notes)

METHOD

1. **Cook the noodles.** Boil the vermicelli for 3–5 minutes, until just tender. Drain, rinse under cold water and drain well.
2. **Season the beef.** Toss the beef with the garlic, fish sauce and sugar.
3. **Fry the beef.** Heat the oil in a wok or large pan over high heat until it shimmers. Add the beef in one layer and stir-fry for about 2 minutes, until browned outside and just cooked.
4. **Build the bowls.** Layer lettuce, bean sprouts and herbs in two bowls, then the noodles, then the beef with its juices.
5. **Serve.** Scatter over the peanuts and fried shallots. Pour the nước chấm over just before eating.

NOTES

- The sauce is the classic dressing of fish sauce, lime juice, sugar, garlic and water. The site's nước chấm is a stronger concentrate: thin about 75 ml of it with 75 ml warm water.
- Fish sauce, rice vermicelli and fried shallots come from an Asian grocer; the herbs, lettuce and beef from any supermarket.
- Lemongrass in the beef makes it bún bò xả (see Similar recipes).